



Neural Wave

AI Hackathon

16.–18. October 2026
Lugano, CH

≈ Be Part of **Neural Wave 2** (16.–18.10.2026)

Embark on an exciting hackathon where AI techniques are leveraged to tackle real-world challenges that shape the future. Talented teams from all over Switzerland and abroad will travel to Lugano for a weekend to develop solutions to your individual needs using AI! Teams compete for prize money while you get 2–4 unique solutions to your problem.

> Propose your own challenge now! Bring your datasets and let participants come up with innovative solutions!

Computer Vision

Recommender
Systems

Natural Language
Processing

Explainable AI

Anomaly Detection

Generative AI

Time Series
Forecasting

≈ How was the first edition of **Neural Wave** ?

Is it worth it to join **Neural Wave 2**? Let's check the companies' outcomes from our first edition.

Success Stories: All projects got solved and improved over the companies' baselines.

- ★ **Swisscom:** Teams built a RAG system (chatbot) which Swisscom evaluated themselves and the best submission was preferred over their own deployed chatbot.
- ★ **Duferco:** Recall-sensitive control application where the best submission reached a recall of 97.6/100 on their hidden test dataset. Duferco did not have a solution or labeled dataset for their problem.
- ★ **Bosch:** They proposed a public educational challenge for causal detection in production lines, which was correctly solved by two teams.
- ★ **AI4Privacy:** Provided a privacy masking benchmark where all teams improved over the startup's baseline.
- ★ **PastaHR:** Needed an interactive AI recruiter that could automatically conduct initial job screenings via phone calls. PastaHR did not have a solution and received two full-fledged MVPs.

≈ Flashback: Neural Wave 2024



<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Kk3w4KxhwKq>

≈ Flashback: Neural Wave 2024

The screenshot shows the Neural Wave website interface. At the top left is the Neural Wave logo. To its right is a navigation menu with links: Home, Location, Schedule, FAQs, and Series. Further right are social media icons for Instagram, Twitter, YouTube, and LinkedIn. The main content area features the title 'Neural Wave 2024' in a large font. Below the title are two tags: a location tag 'Lugano, CH' and a date tag '25-27 Oct 2024'. At the bottom, there are five statistics displayed in individual boxes: 5 Projects, 17 Teams, 62 Participants, 21 Countries, and 10K CHF of Price Pool.

Neural Wave

Home Location Schedule FAQs Series

Instagram Twitter YouTube LinkedIn

Neural Wave 2024

Lugano, CH 25-27 Oct 2024

5	17	62	21	10K
Projects	Teams	Participants	Countries	CHF of Price Pool

Check Last Years Recap: <https://neuralwave.ch/#/series/2024>

≈ Last Edition's Partners

Main Partners



HASLERSTIFTUNG

Silver Partners



Bronze Partners



**BRIGHTSIDE
CAPITAL**



**HCLTech Confinale
Wealth Solutions**



CSCS
Centro Svizzero di Calcolo Scientifico
Swiss National Supercomputing Centre

Project Partners



Duferco



Ai4Privacy

Compute Partner



Other Partners

★★★★
HOTEL LIDO SEEGARTEN
LUGANO



≈ Sponsorship Packages

	Keynote	Project Proposal Discount	Booth Space	Marketing Visibility	Post-Event Access to Hiring Pool
Main Partner 10'000 CHF	✓	100%	✓	Primary	✓
Gold Partner 5'000 CHF	✓	50%	✓	High	✓
Silver Partner 2'500CHF	x	25%	✓	Medium	✓
Bronze Partner 1'500 CHF	x	x	upon availability	Standard	✓

Please note that the VAT of 8.1% is not included in the prices.

≈ Sponsorship Packages

Main Partner

10'000 CHF

- Prime placement of company logo on all promotional materials
- Social media promotion highlighting them as a Main Partner
- Booth space in the expo area
- Opportunity to deliver a keynote
- Free project proposal
- Dedicated recognition in opening and closing ceremonies
- Access to participants contact lists and CVs
- Opportunity to provide branded materials in participants tote bags

Please note that the VAT of 8.1% is not included in the prices.

≈ Sponsorship Packages

Gold Partner

5'000 CHF

- The company logo is displayed prominently on our website and marketing materials
- Social media promotion advertising gold sponsorship
- Booth space in the expo area
- Opportunity to deliver a keynote
- 50% discount on project proposal
- Recognition in the opening and closing ceremony
- Access to participants contact lists and CVs
- Opportunity to provide branded materials in participants tote bags

Please note that the VAT of 8.1% is not included in the prices.

≈ Sponsorship Packages

Silver Partner

2'500 CHF

- Company logo displayed on event website and selected promotional materials
- Social media promotion promoting silver sponsorship
- Booth space in the expo area
- 25% discount on project proposal
- Recognition in event communications and programs
- Access to participants contact lists and CVs
- Opportunity to provide branded materials in participants tote bags

Please note that the VAT of 8.1% is not included in the prices.

≈ Sponsorship Packages

Bronze Partner

1'500 CHF

- Company logo displayed on event website and selected promotional materials
- Social media promotion promoting bronze sponsorship
- Booth space in the expo area if space is available (other tiers have priority)
- Recognition in event communications and programs
- Access to participants contact lists and CVs
- Opportunity to provide branded materials in participants tote bags

Please note that the VAT of 8.1% is not included in the prices.

≈ Propose a Project

Propose a project, get its feasibility evaluated, and get a minimum-viable product (MVP) from the participants.

Fee for offering a challenge:

→ 2'000 CHF

Last year we had at least three teams per project (3-5 people per team).

Success Stories: All projects from the previous edition got solved and improved over the companies' baselines.

- **Swisscom:** Teams built a RAG system (chatbot) which Swisscom evaluated and the best submission was generally preferred over their internal chatbot.
- **Duferco:** Recall-sensitive control application where the best submission reached a recall of 97.6/100 on their hidden test dataset. Duferco did not have a solution or labeled dataset for their problem.
- **Bosch:** They proposed a public educational challenge for causal detection in production lines, which was correctly solved by two teams.
- **AI4Privacy:** Provided a privacy masking benchmark where all teams improved over the startup's baseline.
- **PastaHR:** Needed an interactive AI recruiter that could automatically conduct initial job screenings via phone calls. PastaHR did not have a solution and received two full-fledged MVPs.

≈ Timetable – Day 1: Friday

17:00 Doors Open & Welcome Apéro

Sponsors, Corporates, and Participants get to know each other and set up for the weekend.

18:00 Intro & Keynotes

Main sponsors give keynotes, hackathon staff presents the proposed projects and explains the rules.

19:30 Hackathon begins!

21:00 Snacks & Refreshments

The event continues through the night.

≈ Timetable – Day 2: Saturday

9:00 Breakfast

10:00 Set Up Corporate Booths

Corporates and Sponsors set up and open their booths.

13:00 Lunch & Networking

14:00–17:00 Corporate Expo

Participants visit the expo area and get in touch with you!

18:00 Dinner

The event continues through the night.

≈ Timetable – Day 3: Sunday

9:00 Breakfast

13:00 Results Deadline & Lunch

13:00–16:15 Jury Evaluates Projects

16:30 Award Ceremony

The jury evaluates the projects and picks the winners and awards the prizes.

17:00 Closing Remarks & End of Event

Main sponsors and hackathon staff.

≈ Venue: Aula Magna (USI)



- 300 m² of space
- can host up to 100 participants

Via Buffi 13,
6900 Lugano

≈ Team



**Andrea Brites
Marto**



**Michele
Cattaneo**



**Auréliane
Dubuis**



**Alessandro
Giagnorio**



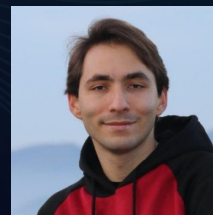
**Nicolai
Hermann**



**Sophie
Kergassner**



**Edoardo
Riggio**



**Elvi Mihai
Sabau Sabau**



**Stefano
Taillefert**

≈ Contact

Look us up on neuralwave.ch

Reach us at info@neuralwave.ch

Find us in [Via La Santa 1, 6900 Lugano](#)

≈ FAQ

Is it possible to be both a sponsor and a project partner?

> Of course, depending on the sponsor tier you will receive a discount for project proposals.

Do we need to provide computational resources if we propose a project?

> We will provide sufficient GPU resources to all teams. If you would like to be our compute sponsor, please get in touch!

How many participants were present at the last edition?

> Out of 132 applications, we accepted around 100 participants of which 62 followed through. This year we are aiming for 100 participants which is the physical limit of our venue. More about our last edition here: neuralwave.ch/#/series/2024.

≈ FAQ

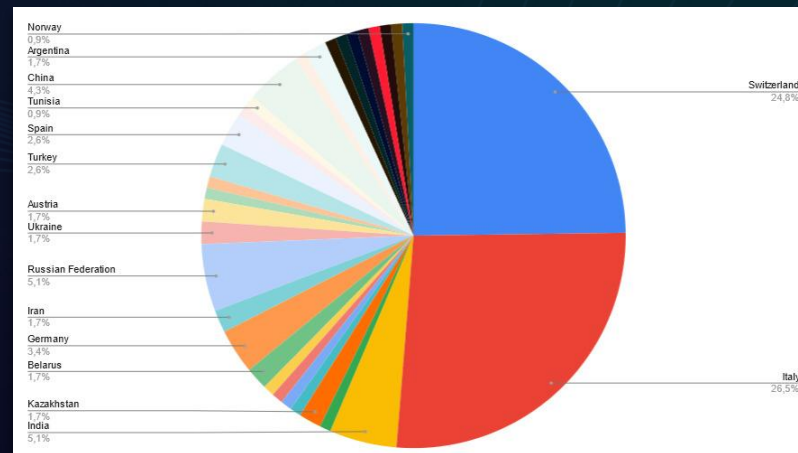
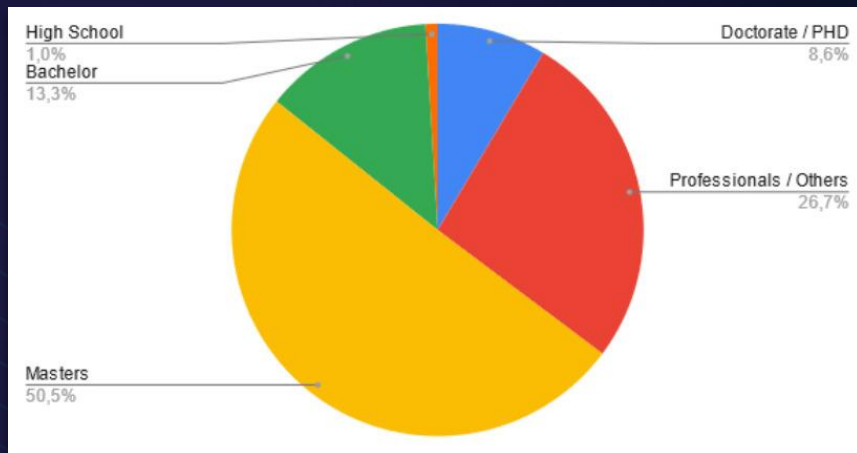
Should a representative be physically present during the entire event?

› It is not strictly necessary to be there all the time but it was well received by the participants to have an exchange with representatives. We would recommend to come to the opening apero (17:30–19:30), the expo on Saturday (14:00–17:00), and the award ceremony on Sunday (around 16:30–17:30). Technical support for questions and clarifications about the project is highly recommended as this will improve the quality of the submissions, you will get to know participants' skills for potential hires, and to build a connection with the teams. Online support would be possible, too. If you must pick, we highly encourage to be present on Saturday as the most exchange will happen during the expo hours. Feel the atmosphere, enjoy good food and get in touch with everyone!

≈ FAQ

Who are the participants and can Deep Learning expertise be assumed?

> Below we depict some demographics of last edition's participants. All participants are screened in an application process before acceptance to ensure a level of background on Data Science and Deep Learning techniques.



≈ FAQ

What about intellectual properties (IP)?

› We do not claim any rights on IP. The IP will stay with the teams but their code will be published under a permissive license (incl. commercial use). This is a mandatory requirement of one of our main partners, Hasler Foundation.

What will be published after the hackathon?

› The code developed by the participants during the hackathon will be published on GitHub under a permissive license (incl. commercial use). Material provided by the companies will not be published! This includes the data that you may provide. The project description may be published. Open sourcing the developed solutions is a hard requirement of one of our main partners, Hasler Foundation.

≈ FAQ

Can we add branded material to the participants' welcome bags?

> Absolutely! Best is to send 120 pieces to us at least two days before the event (14.10.2026). You may also bring branded materials to your booth on Saturday!